

Setswana recordings for Re:Lefela

A word list to read aloud · 132 items · about 10–15 minutes

Thank you so much for doing this. Re:Lefela is a little app my study partner and I built to learn Setswana properly. Every word below is one the app teaches but has no good native recording for yet — right now it uses my own voice, which is not what anyone should be learning pronunciation from.

You do not need to record these one at a time. Just make **one long recording** and read straight down the list. My software finds the silences between words and cuts them apart automatically.

How to record

- **A quiet room matters more than a good microphone.** A phone voice recorder is perfectly fine. What breaks the automatic cutting is background noise — a TV, music, a fan, an open window — because then the gaps between words are not really silent and the software cannot find them.
- **Leave about two seconds between each word.** Say the word, then count *one...two* in your head, then say the next one. A generous gap is the single most helpful thing you can do; too short is the one mistake that is hard for me to fix.
- **Say only the Setswana.** Please do not read the English out loud — it doubles the number of pieces I have to sort through afterwards.
- **Say each word once,** at a normal, unhurried pace. Short words like *mae* and *koko* especially — please do not clip them short.
- **Go in order and please do not skip any.** The numbering is how I match each recording back to the right word in the app. If you would rather not say something, say the number out loud instead (“twenty-nine”) so I can see the gap.
- **If you fluff one, just pause and say it again.** No need to start over — I keep the last version of anything said twice.
- **Take breaks whenever you like.** A long pause does no harm at all. If you would rather record it over a few sittings, that is completely fine — just tell me where you stopped.

If something looks wrong

I built this list from a Peace Corps course and a few published sources, so some of it may be old-fashioned, spelled the South African way rather than the Botswana way, or simply wrong. **Please do not quietly correct it as you read** — if I do not know a word changed, the recording and the app will disagree with each other and the app will teach the wrong thing.

Instead: **say it the way the list has it**, then use the **Notes** column to tell me what it should be. If an English translation is off, note that too. I would genuinely rather find out now than have us learning it wrong all semester.

The word list

Read straight down. Setswana only — the English is just so you can check it.

#	Setswana — say this	English (check me)	Notes
Dumela!			
1	Ke teng	I am fine	
2	Re a leboga	Thank you (we thank)	
Batho le dilo			
3	motho	person	
4	batho	people	
5	leina	name	
6	lelapa	family / home	
Ke a ja!			
7	Ke batla kofi	I want coffee	
Ga ke itse!			
8	Nnyaa, ga ke na mathata	No, I don't have a problem	
9	Ga ke batle tee	I don't want tea	
10	Ga ba bue Sekgoa	They don't speak English	
Tlhogo ya me			
11	mmele	body	
12	tlhogo	head	
13	sefatlhego	face	
14	moriri	hair	
15	leitlho	eye	
16	tsebe	ear	
17	nko	nose	
18	molomo	mouth	
19	leino	tooth	
20	loleme	tongue	
21	molala	neck	
Diatla le dinao			
22	letsogo	arm / hand	
23	seatla	hand	
24	monwana	finger	
25	mpa	stomach / belly	

#	Setswana — say this	English (check me)	Notes
26	mala	stomach / insides	
27	pelo	heart	
28	leoto	leg	
29	lonao	foot	

Ke ngaka!

30	ngaka	doctor	
31	morutabana	teacher	
32	Mpho ke ngaka	Mpho is a doctor	
33	Ke morutabana	I am a teacher	
34	Ga se ngaka	He/she is not a doctor	
35	Mpho o mo ntlong	Mpho is in the house	
36	Le ene ke moithaopi wa Peace Corps	He too is a Peace Corps volunteer	
37	O na le bana ba le babedi	He/she has two children	

Mmele o montle

38	mogolo	big / great / elder	
39	monnye	small / young	
40	moleele	tall / long	
41	khutshwane	short	
42	monate	nice / tasty / sweet	
43	Mpho o montle	Mpho is beautiful	
44	Dikgomo di bogale	The cows are fierce	
45	Dikgomo di dintle	The cows are beautiful	
46	Ke na le dikgomo tse dintle	I have beautiful cows	
47	O opela sentle	You sing well	
48	Ke rata nama thata	I like meat a lot	

Mebala

49	bontsho	black	
50	bosweu	white	
51	bohibidu	red	
52	botala	green / blue	
53	botala jwa tlhaga	green (grass-colour)	
54	botala jwa legodimo	blue (sky-colour)	
55	bosetlha	yellow	
56	borokwa	brown	
57	selaole	purple	

#	Setswana — say this	English (check me)	Notes
58	Pitse e tshweu	A white horse	
59	Pitse e ntsho	A black horse	
60	Tlhale e khibidu	A red thread	
Kwa ngakeng			
61	botlhoko	sore / painful	
Ke a batla			
62	Ga a batle	She/he does not want	
Ke ne ke batla			
63	Re ne re batla	We wanted	
Ke tla batla			
64	Ga a kake a batla	She/he will not want	
Mo tlelaseng			
65	moithuti	learner / student	
66	pensele	pencil	
Maabane le kamoso			
67	gompieno	today	
68	maabane	yesterday	
69	kamoso	tomorrow	
70	phakela	in the morning / early	
71	motshegare	at midday / in the afternoon	
72	maitseboa	in the evening	
73	bosigo	at night	
74	gone jaanong	right now / at the moment	
75	kgantele	later on	
Ke ile kwa sekolong			
76	Ke ile kwa sekolong	I went to school	
77	Mpho o ile kwa sekolong	Mpho went to school	
78	Ke tlhotse kwa sekolong	I spent the day at school	
79	Ke ne ke ithuta Setswana	I was learning Setswana	
80	O ne a ruta	She/he was teaching	
81	Re ne re dira dilo tse dintsi	We were doing many things	

#	Setswana — say this	English (check me)	Notes
82	Ke ne ke itumetse	I was happy	
83	Ke ratile	I taught	
Ke tla ya kwa sekolong			
84	Ke tla ya kwa sekolong	I will go to school	
85	Ke tla ithuta	I will learn / study	
86	Ke tla ruta	I will teach	
87	Re tla bala buka	We will read a book	
88	O tla ya kwa sekolong kamoso	You will go to school tomorrow	
89	Ba tla ithuta Setswana	They will learn Setswana	
Dijo			
90	nama	meat	
91	merogo	vegetables	
Go dira mafoko			
92	go apaya	to cook	
93	moapei	a cook	
94	dino	drinks	
95	moruti	teacher / preacher	
96	modiri	a worker	
97	Re apaya merogo	We are cooking vegetables	
Ba le babedi			
98	Namune e le nngwe	One orange	
99	Batho ba le babedi	Two people	
100	Dikgomo di le pedi	Two cows	
101	Re na le baithuti ba le kae?	How many students do we have?	
102	Dikgomo tse pedi di a ja	The two cows are eating	
Le, mme, kgotsa			
103	le	and / with	
104	Ke rata nama ya koko le nama ya kgomo	I like chicken and beef	
105	mme	but	
106	kgotsa	or	
107	A o batla go ja nama ya kgomo kgotsa ya koko?	Do you want to eat beef or chicken?	

#	Setswana — say this	English (check me)	Notes
108	ka gore	because	
109	Ke rata seswaa, ka gore ke nama	I like seswaa, because it is meat	
110	Seswaa ke nama. Ka jalo, ke a se rata	Seswaa is meat. Therefore, I like it	

Diphologolo tsa kwa gae

111	phologolo	animal	
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Diphologolo tsa naga

112	tau	lion	
113	phiri	wolf / hyena	
114	noga	snake	
115	nonyane	bird	
116	tlhapi	fish	
117	kammele	camel	
118	lephoi	dove	

Go bala ka diphologolo

119	Bonang dinonyane!	See the birds!	
120	Ke na le dinku le dipodi	I have sheep and goats	
121	Dikgomo di dintsi	The cattle are many	

Maele a diphologolo

122	Nnang botlhale jaaka dinoga	Be wise as snakes	
123	bori jaaka maphoi	harmless as doves	
124	Ke lo roma jaaka dinku mo gare ga diphiri	I send you out as sheep among wolves	
125	Tau ya lotso lwa Juda	The Lion of the tribe of Judah	
126	Ke Modisa yo o Molemo	I am the good shepherd	

Go ranola

127	Ke na le podi	I have a goat	
128	Ke na le ntša	I have a dog	
129	Ke bona nonyane	I see a bird	
130	Nku e ntsho	A black sheep	
131	Dintša di bogale	The dogs are fierce	
132	Ke rata diphologolo	I like animals	

That is everything — thank you again. Any format is fine: WhatsApp voice note, phone recording, whatever is

easiest.

For Megan — tagging reference

Not for the speaker. Recording order → card id. **new** = first recording (new file). **redo** = overwrites an existing audio/items/<id>.mp3, so this wave WILL need AUDIO_CACHE (relefela-audio-vN) bumped in sw.js. Same data as toolkit/recording-list.json.

1	u1l1-07 redo	Ke teng	67	u3l6-01 new	gompieno
2	u1l1-08 redo	Re a leboga	68	u3l6-02 new	maabane
3	u1l5-01 redo	motho	69	u3l6-03 new	kamoso
4	u1l5-02 redo	batho	70	u3l6-04 new	phakela
5	u1l5-07 redo	leina	71	u3l6-05 new	motshegare
6	u1l5-10 redo	lelapa	72	u3l6-06 new	maitseboa
7	u1l6-09 redo	Ke batla kofi	73	u3l6-07 new	bosigo
8	u1l7-06 redo	Nnyaa, ga ke na mathata	74	u3l6-08 new	gone jaanong
9	u1l7-07 redo	Ga ke batle tee	75	u3l6-09 new	kgantele
10	u1l7-08 redo	Ga ba bue Sekgoa	76	u3l7-01 new	Ke ile kwa sekolong
11	u2l1-01 redo	mmele	77	u3l7-02 new	Mpho o ile kwa sekolong
12	u2l1-02 redo	tlhogo	78	u3l7-03 new	Ke tlhotse kwa sekolong
13	u2l1-03 redo	sefatlhego	79	u3l7-04 new	Ke ne ke ithuta Setswana
14	u2l1-04 redo	moriri	80	u3l7-05 new	O ne a ruta
15	u2l1-05 redo	leitlho	81	u3l7-06 new	Re ne re dira dilo tse dintsi
16	u2l1-06 redo	tsebe	82	u3l7-07 new	Ke ne ke itumetse
17	u2l1-07 redo	nko	83	u3l7-08 new	Ke rutile
18	u2l1-08 redo	molomo	84	u3l8-01 new	Ke tla ya kwa sekolong
19	u2l1-09 redo	leino	85	u3l8-03 new	Ke tla ithuta
20	u2l1-10 redo	loleme	86	u3l8-04 new	Ke tla ruta
21	u2l1-11 redo	molala	87	u3l8-05 new	Re tla bala buka
22	u2l2-01 redo	letsogo	88	u3l8-06 new	O tla ya kwa sekolong kamoso
23	u2l2-02 redo	seatla	89	u3l8-07 new	Ba tla ithuta Setswana
24	u2l2-03 redo	monwana	90	u4l1-02 new	nama
25	u2l2-04 redo	mpa	91	u4l1-08 new	merogo
26	u2l2-05 redo	mala	92	u4l2-01 new	go apaya
27	u2l2-06 redo	pelo	93	u4l2-02 new	moapei
28	u2l2-07 redo	leoto	94	u4l2-03 new	dino
29	u2l2-08 redo	lonao	95	u4l2-04 new	moruti
30	u2l4-01 redo	ngaka	96	u4l2-05 new	modiri
31	u2l4-02 redo	morutabana	97	u4l2-06 new	Re apaya merogo
32	u2l4-03 redo	Mpho ke ngaka	98	u4l4-01 new	Namune e le nngwe
33	u2l4-04 redo	Ke morutabana	99	u4l4-02 new	Batho ba le babedi
34	u2l4-05 redo	Ga se ngaka	100	u4l4-03 new	Dikgomo di le pedi
35	u2l4-06 redo	Mpho o mo ntlong	101	u4l4-05 new	Re na le baithuti ba le kae?
36	u2l4-07 redo	Le ene ke moithaopi wa Peace Corps	102	u4l4-06 new	Dikgomo tse pedi di a ja
37	u2l4-08 redo	O na le bana ba le babedi	103	u4l5-01 new	le
38	u2l5-01 redo	mogolo	104	u4l5-02 new	Ke rata nama ya koko le nama ya kgomo
39	u2l5-02 redo	monnye	105	u4l5-03 new	mme
40	u2l5-03 redo	moleele	106	u4l5-04 new	kgotsa
41	u2l5-04 redo	khutshwane	107	u4l5-05 new	A o batla go ja nama ya kgomo kgotsa ya koko?
42	u2l5-05 redo	monate	108	u4l5-06 new	ka gore

43	u2l5-06 redo	Mpho o montle	109	u4l5-07 new	Ke rata seswaa, ka gore ke nama
44	u2l5-07 redo	Dikgomo di bogale	110	u4l5-08 new	Seswaa ke nama. Ka jalo, ke a se rata
45	u2l5-08 redo	Dikgomo di dintle	111	u5l1-01 new	phologolo
46	u2l5-09 redo	Ke na le dikgomo tse dintle	112	u5l2-01 new	tau
47	u2l5-11 redo	O opela sentle	113	u5l2-02 new	phiri
48	u2l5-12 redo	Ke rata nama thata	114	u5l2-03 new	noga
49	u2l6-01 redo	bontsho	115	u5l2-04 new	nonyane
50	u2l6-02 redo	bosweu	116	u5l2-05 new	tlhapi
51	u2l6-03 redo	bohibidu	117	u5l2-06 new	kammele
52	u2l6-04 redo	botala	118	u5l2-07 new	lephoi
53	u2l6-05 redo	botala jwa tlhaga	119	u5l3-06 new	Bonang dinonyane!
54	u2l6-06 redo	botala jwa legodimo	120	u5l3-07 new	Ke na le dinku le dipodi
55	u2l6-07 redo	bosetlha	121	u5l3-08 new	Dikgomo di dintsi
56	u2l6-08 redo	borokwa	122	u5l4-01 new	Nnang botlhale jaaka dinoga
57	u2l6-09 redo	selaole	123	u5l4-02 new	bori jaaka maphoi
58	u2l6-10 redo	Pitse e tshweu	124	u5l4-03 new	Ke lo roma jaaka dinku mo gare ga diphiri
59	u2l6-11 redo	Pitse e ntsho	125	u5l4-04 new	Tau ya lotso lwa Juda
60	u2l6-12 redo	Tlhale e khibidu	126	u5l4-05 new	Ke Modisa yo o Molemo
61	u2l7-08 redo	botlhoko	127	u5l5-01 new	Ke na le podi
62	u3l1-08 redo	Ga a batle	128	u5l5-02 new	Ke na le ntša
63	u3l2-04 redo	Re ne re batla	129	u5l5-03 new	Ke bona nonyane
64	u3l3-08 redo	Ga a kake a batla	130	u5l5-04 new	Nku e ntsho
65	u3l4-01 new	moithuti	131	u5l5-05 new	Dintša di bogale
66	u3l4-06 new	pensele	132	u5l5-06 new	Ke rata diphologolo